Blueberry Chia Overnight Oats

Estimated Recipe Cost: $2.47

Cost Per Serving: $1.24

Ingredients

- 1 cup rolled oats
- 2 cups 2% milk
- 2 tablespoons chia seeds
- 1 cup fresh blueberries
- 2 teaspoons honey
- 2 tablespoons chopped walnuts (optional)

Directions

1. Combine the oats, milk, chia seeds, and honey in a mason jar or bowl.
2. Stir well until the chia seeds are evenly distributed.
3. Cover and refrigerate overnight or for at least 4 hours.
4. Top with fresh blueberries and walnuts before serving.
5. Serve chilled or warm for 30 seconds in the microwave.



Chickpea Quinoa Power Bowl

Estimated Recipe Cost: $5.36

Cost Per Serving: $2.68

Ingredients

- 1 cup cooked quinoa
- 1 (15 oz) can chickpeas, drained and rinsed
- 2 cups baby spinach
- 1 cup cherry tomatoes, halved
- 1 avocado, sliced
- 1 tablespoon olive oil
- Juice of ½ lemon
- Salt and pepper to taste

Directions

1. Cook the quinoa according to the package directions.
2. Divide the spinach between two bowls.
3. Top with quinoa, chickpeas, tomatoes, and avocado.
4. Whisk together the olive oil, lemon juice, salt, and pepper.
5. Drizzle over the bowls and gently toss before serving.



Lemon Garlic Salmon with Sweet Potato & Broccoli

Estimated Recipe Cost: $11.42

Cost Per Serving: $5.71

Ingredients

- 2 Atlantic salmon fillets (about 6 oz each)
- 1 large sweet potato, cubed
- 2 cups broccoli florets
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 tablespoon olive oil
- Juice of 1 lemon
- 1 teaspoon paprika
- Salt and pepper to taste

Directions

1. Preheat the oven to **400°F**.
2. Toss the sweet potato with olive oil, paprika, salt, and pepper and roast for 15 minutes.
3. Add the broccoli to the baking sheet.
4. Season the salmon with garlic, lemon juice, salt, pepper, and paprika.
5. Place the salmon on the baking sheet beside the vegetables.
6. Bake for an additional 12–15 minutes, or until the salmon flakes easily with a fork.
7. Serve immediately.



Peanut Butter Chickpea Energy Bites

Estimated Recipe Cost: $3.84

Makes: 12 energy bites

Cost Per Energy Bite: $0.32

Ingredients

- 1 (15 oz) can chickpeas, drained and rinsed
- ½ cup creamy peanut butter
- ½ cup rolled oats
- ¼ cup honey
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract
- ¼ cup dark chocolate chips (optional)

Directions

1. Drain and rinse the chickpeas, then pat them dry.
2. Blend the chickpeas in a food processor until smooth.
3. Add the peanut butter, honey, and vanilla extract and blend until creamy.
4. Mix in the oats and chocolate chips.
5. Roll into 12 equal-sized balls.
6. Refrigerate for at least 20 minutes before serving.
7. Store in an airtight container in the refrigerator for up to one week.



Peanut Butter Banana Oatmeal Bowl

Servings: 1
Meal: Breakfast
Prep Time: 5 minutes
Cook Time: 5 minutes
Total Time: 10 minutes
Estimated Cost: $1.00–$1.50 per serving

Description

This creamy Peanut Butter Banana Oatmeal Bowl is a comforting breakfast packed with fiber, protein, and healthy fats to help fuel busy mornings. It is affordable, filling, and made with simple pantry staples, making it an excellent choice for pregnant and breastfeeding mothers.

Ingredients

- 1 cup rolled oats
- 1 cup milk (or shelf-stable milk)
- 1 medium banana, sliced
- 1 tablespoon peanut butter
- ½ teaspoon cinnamon (optional)

Directions

1. In a small saucepan, bring the milk to a gentle simmer over medium heat.
2. Stir in the oats and cook according to the package directions, stirring occasionally until creamy.
3. Remove from the heat and fold in half of the sliced banana.
4. Transfer the oatmeal to a serving bowl.
5. Top with the remaining banana slices and peanut butter.
6. Sprinkle with cinnamon, if desired, and serve warm.

Chef's Tips

- Add a tablespoon of chia seeds or ground flaxseed for extra omega-3 fats and fiber.
- For additional sweetness, drizzle with a small amount of honey.

- Store leftovers in the refrigerator for up to three days.

Nutrition Highlights

- High in fiber
- Excellent source of potassium
- Good source of calcium
- Provides protein and healthy fats

Pregnancy & Breastfeeding Benefits

- Supports healthy fetal growth through protein intake.
- Helps reduce constipation with dietary fiber.
- Provides calcium for bone development.
- Offers sustained energy throughout the day.



One-Pot Lentil Tomato Stew

Servings: 4
Meal: Lunch or Dinner
Prep Time: 10 minutes
Cook Time: 30 minutes
Total Time: 40 minutes
Estimated Cost: $1.50–$2.00 per serving

Description

This hearty lentil tomato stew combines affordable pantry ingredients into a nutritious meal rich in plant-based protein, iron, and folate. It is perfect for meal prep and freezes well for busy weeks.

Ingredients

- 1 cup dried lentils, rinsed
- 1 can (14.5 oz) diced tomatoes
- 1 bag frozen mixed vegetables
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 4 cups vegetable or chicken broth
- 1 teaspoon garlic powder
- ½ teaspoon black pepper
- Salt to taste

Directions

1. Heat a large pot over medium heat. If desired, lightly sauté the diced onion until softened.
2. Add the lentils, diced tomatoes, frozen vegetables, broth, garlic powder, and black pepper.
3. Bring the mixture to a boil.
4. Reduce the heat, cover, and simmer for approximately 30 minutes, or until the lentils are tender.
5. Season with salt to taste.
6. Serve warm with whole-grain bread or brown rice.

Chef's Tips

- Add spinach during the last five minutes of cooking for extra nutrients.
- Freeze leftovers in individual portions for quick meals.
- Adjust the consistency by adding more broth if needed.

Nutrition Highlights

- High in plant-based protein
- Rich in iron
- Excellent source of folate
- High in dietary fiber

Pregnancy & Breastfeeding Benefits

- Supports healthy neural tube development through folate.
- Helps reduce the risk of iron-deficiency anemia.
- Provides sustained energy.
- Supports milk production with quality protein.



Pantry Chicken & Rice Power Bowl

Servings: 4
Meal: Lunch or Dinner
Prep Time: 10 minutes
Cook Time: 20 minutes
Total Time: 30 minutes
Estimated Cost: $2.00–$3.00 per serving

Description

This quick pantry-friendly power bowl combines rice, canned chicken, beans, and vegetables into a balanced meal rich in protein, fiber, and complex carbohydrates. It's perfect for busy families looking for nutritious meals on a budget.

Ingredients

- 1 cup brown or white rice
- 1 can chicken, drained (or canned tuna)
- 1 can black beans, rinsed and drained
- 1 can corn, drained
- ½ cup salsa or diced tomatoes (optional)
- Salt and pepper to taste

Directions

1. Prepare the rice according to the package directions.
2. While the rice cooks, drain the chicken, beans, and corn.
3. Warm the chicken, beans, and corn together in a skillet or microwave.
4. Divide the cooked rice among serving bowls.
5. Top with the chicken mixture.
6. Add salsa or diced tomatoes, if desired.
7. Season with salt and pepper before serving.

Chef's Tips

- Top with sliced avocado for healthy fats.
- Add shredded cheese if desired.
- Substitute canned salmon for additional omega-3 fatty acids.

Nutrition Highlights

- High in protein
- Rich in fiber
- Good source of iron
- Provides long-lasting energy

Pregnancy & Breastfeeding Benefits

- Meets increased protein needs.
- Helps support milk production.
- Provides iron to reduce fatigue.
- Offers balanced carbohydrates for sustained energy.



Greek Yogurt Berry Parfait

Servings: 1
Meal: Snack
Prep Time: 5 minutes
Cook Time: None
Total Time: 5 minutes
Estimated Cost: $1.50–$2.00 per serving

Description

This colorful Greek Yogurt Berry Parfait is a refreshing snack that combines creamy yogurt, antioxidant-rich berries, and crunchy granola. It's a simple, nutrient-dense option that supports both maternal health and breastfeeding nutrition.

Ingredients

- 1 cup plain Greek yogurt
- ½ cup mixed berries (fresh or frozen)
- ¼ cup granola
- 1 teaspoon honey (optional)

Directions

1. Spoon half of the Greek yogurt into a serving glass or bowl.
2. Add half of the berries.
3. Sprinkle half of the granola over the berries.
4. Repeat the layers with the remaining yogurt, berries, and granola.
5. Drizzle with honey, if desired.

6. Serve immediately.

Chef's Tips

- Prepare without granola if storing overnight and add it just before serving.
- Add chopped walnuts or almonds for healthy fats.
- Use frozen berries to reduce cost.

Nutrition Highlights

- Excellent source of calcium
- High in protein
- Rich in probiotics
- Packed with antioxidants

Pregnancy & Breastfeeding Benefits

- Supports bone health through calcium.
- Promotes digestive health with probiotics.
- Provides protein for maternal recovery and milk production.
- Offers antioxidants that support overall maternal wellness.

